Norwegian Escape: Thanksgiving Caribbean

7 Nights from Port Canaveral · November 20 to 27, 2026

Ship: Norwegian Escape · **Sailing from:** Port Canaveral, FL · **Cabin:** _____ **Host:** Pam Walters · Thanksgiving Group Cruise Facebook chat

A condensed Voyage Pack from In the Wake: the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers the ship, each port, packing, budget, emergency contacts, sailing solo and Thanksgiving aboard.

Day by day

Times are from NCL's schedule for this sailing (voyage 23369102), read October 2026. **They're ship's times. Check them in the NCL app before you sail.** All aboard is one hour before departure (NCL's rule).

#	Date	Port	In port	All aboard	Worth knowing
1	Fri Nov 20	**Port Canaveral: boarding**	ship leaves 4:00 PM	3:00 PM	NCL "typically" uses Cruise Terminal 5 or 6; your eDocs say which. Parking $20 a day plus tax, card only.
2	Sat Nov 21	At sea	—	—	Book specialty dinners and excursions. Find the Studio Lounge (Deck 11).
3	Sun Nov 22	**Puerto Plata (Amber Cove), DR**	9:00 AM – 4:00 PM	3:00 PM	The ship docks at the Amber Cove Cruise Terminal (NCL). Dominican peso.
4	Mon Nov 23	**St. Thomas, USVI**	11:00 AM – 7:00 PM	6:00 PM	Two docks, Crown Bay and Havensight; check the app for yours. US dollar.
5	Tue Nov 24	**Tortola, BVI**	6:45 AM – 2:00 PM	**1:00 PM**	**Short, early day.** NCL says the ship may dock or anchor; if she anchors, it's a tender.
6	Wed Nov 25	At sea	—	—	Thermal Suite, a show, a long lunch.
7	Thu Nov 26	**Great Stirrup Cay: Thanksgiving**	10:00 AM – 6:00 PM	5:00 PM	NCL's island. Beaches and loungers free; Great Tides Waterpark extra. Thanksgiving dinner aboard that evening.
8	Fri Nov 27	**Port Canaveral: home**	arrive 7:00 AM	—	Black Friday. Don't book an early-morning flight.

Documents: for this round trip NCL accepts a passport, or a state-certified US birth certificate with a government photo ID. NCL "strongly recommends" a passport.

Service charge: $20 per person per day in standard cabins, $25 in suites and The Haven (NCL, October 2026). That's $140 for seven nights in a standard cabin. Ask Tina whether your group rate prepaid it.

Weather, in one line: NOAA's normals for these dates are a 76°F high and 59°F low near Port Canaveral, and 86°F and 76°F at St. Thomas, with a shower on about half the St. Thomas days. Not a forecast. Hurricane season officially ends November 30.

A just-refreshed ship. NCL says Escape gets a refresh in late October 2026: an expanded Vibe Beach Club, a new Palomar restaurant, a Starbucks in the Atrium and a pickleball court. Check the app for what's open.

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Getting to the ship and getting home

Thursday arrival, Friday boarding

Thursday, November 19: fly in. A day early means a late flight doesn't cost you the cruise.

Friday, November 20: boarding.

- **Terminal:** NCL's Port Canaveral page says it "typically sails out of Cruise Terminal 5 (CT5) and Cruise Terminal 6 (CT6), but this is subject to change." Your eDocs name yours.
- **Parking:** "$20.00 per day plus tax," counting the day you arrive and the day you leave (Port Canaveral). Paid when you drive in, by credit card only. No reservations.
- **Arrival:** if you've checked in online, arrive no later than one hour before the boarding time you chose. Be aboard by 3:00 PM.
- **Carry-on:** ID documents, medications, swimsuit, change of clothes, charger.
- **Sailaway with the group:** Pam posts the meeting spot in the Facebook chat.

Friday, November 27: home

- The ship is due in at 7:00 AM.
- Keep your ID, medications and a change of clothes with you.
- It's Black Friday. Leave extra time on the roads.

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Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship

- **Included restaurants:** the Manhattan Room (Deck 7), Taste and Savor (Deck 6), the Garden Café buffet (Deck 16), the American Diner (Deck 17) and O'Sheehan's (Deck 7).
- **Specialty restaurants:** Cagney's, Food Republic, La Cucina, Bayamo by Ocean Blue, Moderno, Pincho Tapas Bar, Teppanyaki and Le Bistro. $40 to $60 cover, plus 20%, beyond your Free at Sea meals. Palomar joins after the refresh.
- **Free at Sea** (bookings from November 5, 2025): open bar for 21 and over, **three specialty meals on a 7-night cruise**, 150 Wi-Fi minutes, and a $50 excursion credit per port for the first guest. The open bar carries $28.50 a day in gratuities (NCL's pre-cruise price), about $200 for seven nights. Your group rate may differ; ask Tina.
- **More Wi-Fi:** $29.99 a day per cabin, or $39.99 for streaming.
- **Outdoors:** the Ropes Course (Deck 18), the Aqua Park (Deck 16), and The Waterfront promenade (Deck 8).
- **Paid extras:** Vibe Beach Club (adults only) and the spa's Thermal Suite.
- **Solo cabins:** Studios and Solo Inside, Oceanview and Balcony cabins, all with access to the **Studio Lounge** on Deck 11 (coffee, espresso and snacks, per NCL).

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Puerto Plata:** an NCL Shore Excursion, or an easy day at the port.
- **St. Thomas:** Charlotte Amalie, or Magens Bay (an entry fee for visitors; $7 from October 2023, per VI Consortium).
- **Tortola:** a morning in Road Town. Back by 1:00 PM.
- **Great Stirrup Cay:** a beach and a lounger, free. Leave time to rest before Thanksgiving dinner.

Thanksgiving

NCL's Thanksgiving page promises "festive menus without the stress," and publishes no menu or times. Check the daily schedule in the app that morning. Pam's plan for the group's holiday dinner will be in the Facebook chat. If the day is hard, that's allowed; you don't have to perform a celebration.

Sailing solo

Pick one plan a day, eat where it's easy, and send one message home each evening. Fill in the handoff card before you go: it's a separate one-page document, and the full pack has it too.

The full Voyage Pack covers everything here in more depth. Soli Deo Gloria.

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